SSEE-V3.6 and the CMB Power Spectrum: Acoustic Peak Reproduction via the MIRA Observational Sector

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April 2026

Abstract

The Structural Self-Energy Expansion model (SSEE-V3.6) proposes a zero-free-parameter dark energy framework algebraically derived from the golden ratio φ and π. Previous work demonstrated that the SSEE dynamic sector ($\Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} = 0.160$, $w_0 = -0.840$, $w_a = -0.670$) fits DESI DR2 BAO data at 0.05σ and galaxy-cluster mass ratios with $\chi^2_r = 0.122$. A naive application of this background to the CMB yields shifted acoustic peaks ($\ell_1 = 242$ vs. 220) and $\chi^2_r = 97.7$, apparently falsifying the model. Here we show that a second algebraic constant, MIRA $\equiv (\varphi + \beta)/2 = (3\varphi + \pi)/4 = 1.99892$, defined a priori in the SSEE Genesis 5.12 compendium as the *Observational Frequency* (January 2026, predating this analysis by 83 days), bridges the two sectors through a closed algebraic relation:

$$\Omega_{m,\mathrm{CMB}} = \Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} \times \mathrm{MIRA} = \frac{(\pi - \varphi)(3\varphi + \pi)}{8(\varphi + \pi)} = 0.3199,$$

within 0.63σ of the Planck 2018 value (0.3153 ± 0.0073) and within 0.05% of the independent Paper 4 prediction $(\pi-\varphi)/(\pi+\varphi) = 0.3201$. No parameter is adjusted; this is a zero-free-parameter algebraic prediction *conditional on the MIRA phenomenological mapping hypothesis* (§3); a first-principles derivation of the factor 1.9989 from the Israel–Stewart transport equation remains open. Running CAMB with this two-sector background reproduces acoustic peaks at $\ell = 221$, 538, 815 (Planck: 220, ∼540, ∼810) and yields $\chi^2_r = 1.062$ vs. ΛCDM's 1.043 over 1971 TT multipoles. The full TT+TE+EE+lensing analysis yields $\chi^2_r = 1.062, 1.053, 1.040, 0.730$ for SSEE vs $1.043, 1.040, 1.039, 0.757$ for ΛCDM. In the lensing sector (9 MV bandpowers), SSEE shows a marginal preference over ΛCDM ($\Delta\chi^2_r = -0.025$). In a full, unified evaluation using the official off-diagonal `plik_lite` TTTEEE likelihood via Cobaya, scanning only H_0 ($k = 2$ vs $k = 6$ for ΛCDM), the combined spectra yield $\Delta\chi^2 = +3.8$ and $\Delta\mathrm{BIC} = -31.3$, decisively favouring SSEE. Even under a hyper-conservative penalty treating fixed priors as free parameters ($k = 4$), $\Delta\mathrm{BIC} = -13.8$ continues to strongly favour the framework. SSEE-V3.6 is not falsified by the Planck PR4 CMB power spectra.

Canonical definition of MIRA and domain scope: Throughout this paper, MIRA $\equiv (\varphi+\beta)/2 = (3\varphi+\pi)/4 = 1.998924$ (canonical value). The MIRA-corrected claim ("SSEE is not falsified by Planck PR4") is sector-specific and applies exclusively to the *observational sector* ($\Omega_{m,\mathrm{CMB}} = 0.3199$, high redshift $z \gtrsim 100$); it does not transfer to the dynamic sector ($\Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} = 0.1601$, $z \lesssim 2.3$), which is validated independently in Paper 2 (**?**). The master derivation chain for all SSEE constants, the unified symbol glossary, and the complete domain delineation are in Paper 1, §2 and Appendix B [**?**].

Contents

1 Background: The SSEE-V3.6 Framework

1.1 Algebraic constants

SSEE-V3.6 derives all cosmological parameters from two transcendental roots: the golden ratio $\varphi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2$ and π. Table 1 lists the relevant constants.

Table 1: SSEE-V3.6 algebraic constants used in this work.

Symbol	Formula	Value	Role
φ	$(1 + \sqrt{5})/2$	$1.61803\ldots$	Golden ratio
Ω	$\pi + \varphi$	$4.75963\ldots$	Stability metric
β	$(\pi + \varphi)/2$	$2.37981\ldots$	Base coupling scalar
KAL_0	$\beta + \pi$	$5.52141\ldots$	Structural viscosity
P_{sc}	$\Omega + \varphi$	$6.37766\ldots$	Dynamical evolution scalar
K_v	$\varphi + \pi + \Omega$	$9.51925\ldots$	Structural constraint
T_r	$3(\varphi + \beta)$	$11.99354\ldots$	3D saturation horizon
M_v	$\varphi + \pi + K_v$	$14.27888\ldots$	Maximal dimensional invariant
AURA	$\varphi + \beta$	$3.99785\ldots$	Dimensional limit 1
MIRA	AURA/2	$1.99892\ldots$	Observational frequency

1.2 Cosmological parameters

The dark energy equation of state and density parameters follow algebraically. Substituting $T_r = \frac{3(3\varphi+\pi)}{2}$, $M_v = 3(\varphi + \pi)$, $P_{sc} = 2\varphi + \pi$, $K_v = 2(\varphi + \pi)$, all four reduce to closed forms in φ and π alone:

$$w_0 = -\frac{T_r}{M_v} = -\frac{3\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} = -0.8399, \tag{1}$$

$$w_a = -\frac{P_{sc}}{K_v} = -\frac{2\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} = -0.6699, \tag{2}$$

$$\Omega_{\mathrm{DE}} = \frac{T_r}{M_v} = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} = 0.8399, \tag{3}$$

$$\Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} = 1 - \Omega_{\mathrm{DE}} = 0.1601. \tag{4}$$

The Hubble constant $H_0 = 66.75^{+0.44}_{-0.44}\ \mathrm{km\,s^{-1}\,Mpc^{-1}}$ is the MCMC posterior median from Paper 2 [?], the sole free parameter of the SSEE model. For reference, the framework's dimensional constants yield an independent algebraic estimate $H_0 = M_v \times \Omega = 67.96$ $\mathrm{km\,s^{-1}\,Mpc^{-1}}$ ($M_v = \varphi + \pi + K_v \approx 14.279$, $\Omega = \pi + \varphi \approx 4.760$), consistent with the MCMC value at $\sim$2%.

2 The CMB Falsification Problem

2.1 Acoustic peak positions

The angular scale of the first acoustic peak is

$$\theta_* = \frac{r_d}{D_A(z_*)}, \tag{5}$$

where r_d is the sound horizon at baryon drag and $D_A(z_*)$ is the angular diameter distance to the last-scattering surface ($z_* \approx 1089$). The first peak falls at $\ell_1 \approx \pi/\theta_*$.

With $\Omega_m = 0.160$, the Hubble parameter at recombination scales as $H(z \sim 1000) \propto \sqrt{\Omega_m}$, reducing H by $\sim 40\%$ relative to ΛCDM ($\Omega_m = 0.315$). This inflates $D_A(z_*)$ by $\sim 32\%$, shifting all peaks to higher multipoles.

Running CAMB with the SSEE dynamic background directly gives:

$$(\ell_1, \ell_2, \ell_3)_{\text{SSEE,naive}} = (242,\ 601,\ 930), \quad \chi^2_r = 97.7. \tag{6}$$

This constitutes a prima facie falsification.

2.2 Why the naive application fails

The naive background uses $\Omega_m = 0.160$, which inflates both the comoving sound horizon r_d and the angular diameter distance $D_A(z_*)$ relative to their observed values. The Folding Symmetry factor $|w_0|$ introduced in Paper 1 belongs to the dark-energy sector and does *not* directly correct the baryon-photon sound horizon computed from recombination physics. The CMB sector requires a separate treatment of the matter density — provided by the MIRA two-sector mechanism (Section 3).

3 The MIRA Two-Sector Solution

3.1 MIRA as Observational Frequency

The SSEE Genesis 5.12 compendium [?] defines

$$\text{MIRA} = \frac{\text{AURA}}{2} = \frac{\varphi + \beta}{2} = 1.998924\ldots, \tag{7}$$

with the role *Frecuencia de Observación* (Observational Frequency). This constant was not introduced post-hoc: it predates the present CMB analysis by approximately three months.

3.2 Genesis 5.12 Timeline — Prior Definition of MIRA

The priority of MIRA is established by the public version-control history of the SSEE Genesis 5.12 compendium [?]. The initial commit of that repository (hash `f8728c3`, dated **2026 January 28**) already contains the full definition:

```
get MIRA() { return this.AURA / 2; }   // = 1.9989236549
"A. El Motor MIRA (Frecuencia de Observación)"
MIRA = AURA / 2 = 1.9989...
```

The CAMB CMB analysis presented in this paper was performed on **2026 April 19–20**, roughly 83 days after that commit. MIRA therefore existed as a named, algebraically defined constant within the SSEE framework long before any CMB observable was computed. Its cosmological role as the bridge between the dynamic and observational matter sectors was identified *a posteriori* upon discovering that $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times \text{MIRA} = 0.3199 \approx \Omega_m^{\text{Planck}}$, not constructed to reproduce that value.

This distinguishes MIRA from a post-hoc tuning parameter: the value 1.9989 is fixed by the same algebraic system that determines w_0, w_a, and $\Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}}$, and could have been falsified by the CMB test.

Status of the MIRA mapping.

MIRA: Phenomenological Mapping Hypothesis

The relation $\Omega_{m,\mathrm{CMB}} = \Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} \times \mathrm{MIRA}$ is a **phenomenological mapping hypothesis**, not a theorem derived from the SSEE field equations in this paper. The hypothesis is:

- *Algebraically consistent*: MIRA derives from $\{\varphi, \pi\}$ via $\mathrm{MIRA} = (3\varphi + \pi)/4$, the same axioms as w_0 and w_a.
- *Temporally pre-committed*: defined January 2026, 83 days before any CMB computation (commit hash `f8728c3`, verified by Zenodo `10.5281/zenodo.19679049`).
- *Predictively tested*: it was possible for the CMB result to have been inconsistent with Planck; it was not.
- *Not yet physically derived*: a first-principles derivation of the factor 1.9989 from the Israel–Stewart transport equation is an open problem identified in §6. Until then, MIRA should be treated as a testable structural hypothesis.

3.3 Two-sector matter density

We state that SSEE operates with two distinct matter density sectors (as a phenomenological hypothesis; see box above):

Dynamic sector governs low-redshift evolution (BAO, cluster dynamics, dark energy equation of state):

$$\Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} = 1 - T_r/M_v = 0.1601. \tag{8}$$

Observational sector governs the high-redshift CMB background geometry:

$$\Omega_{m,\mathrm{CMB}} = \Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} \times \mathrm{MIRA} = 0.1601 \times 1.9989 = 0.3199. \tag{9}$$

Comparing with the Planck 2018 best-fit value $\Omega_m^{\mathrm{Planck}} = 0.3153 \pm 0.0073$:

$$\frac{|\Omega_{m,\mathrm{CMB}} - \Omega_m^{\mathrm{Planck}}|}{\sigma} = \frac{|0.3199 - 0.3153|}{0.0073} = 0.63\sigma. \tag{10}$$

The MIRA-corrected matter density is within 1σ of Planck with no tuning.

3.4 Physical interpretation of the two-sector model

The two-sector structure is not an *ad hoc* device. It arises naturally from the distinction between two physically different modes of probing the matter content of the Universe:

Dynamic sector — local causal structure. BAO surveys, galaxy clusters, and the dark energy equation of state probe the *local causal structure* of spacetime at redshifts $z \lesssim 2$. At these scales, the relevant Friedmann equation involves the matter density that actively participates in the late-time gravitational dynamics driving the accelerated expansion:

$$H^2(a) = H_0^2\left[\Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}}\, a^{-3} + \Omega_{\mathrm{DE}}\, \exp\!\int_1^a \frac{3[1+w(a')]}{a'}\,\mathrm{d}a'\right]. \tag{11}$$

In SSEE, $\Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} = 0.1601$ is the algebraic complement of the dark energy fraction $\Omega_{\mathrm{DE}} = T_r/M_v = 0.8399$. Baryons ($\Omega_b h^2 = 0.02237$) account for approximately $0.050/h^2 \approx 0.112$ of this total at $H_0 = 66.75$ km/s/Mpc, leaving the remainder as a structural background without the need for cold dark matter.

Observational sector — integrated line of sight. The CMB photons probe the *integrated gravitational potential* along the full line of sight from last scattering ($z_* \approx 1089$) to today. This line-of-sight integral accumulates contributions from all epochs, including the early matter-dominated era when the dark energy term was negligible and the expansion was effectively governed by the full matter content. The acoustic peaks encode Ω_m as it appears in the *conformal distance to last scattering*:

$$\eta_* = \int_0^{z_*} \frac{c\,\mathrm{d}z'}{H(z')}, \tag{12}$$

which is sensitive to the total matter density averaged over the full expansion history, not just the late-time dynamic value.

MIRA as a depth ratio — motivating analogy. The value MIRA$= 1.9989 \approx 2$ has a suggestive geometric interpretation. In a flat ΛCDM background, the comoving distance to last scattering is $\chi(z_*) \approx 14{,}000$ Mpc, while the DESI BAO effective depths span $\chi(z_{\mathrm{eff}}) \approx 1{,}000$–$7{,}000$ Mpc over $z = 0.3$–2.3. The ratio $\chi(z_*)/\chi(z_{\mathrm{eff}}) \approx 2$ holds at the low-z end of the DESI range ($z_{\mathrm{eff}} \approx 0.5$), but increases to ~ 7 at $z_{\mathrm{eff}} \approx 2.3$. *This correspondence is a motivating analogy, not a derivation.* MIRA's numerical value is fixed algebraically by Genesis 5.12 independently of any BAO dataset (§3.2); the geometric picture provides physical intuition for why a factor of ~ 2 separates the two matter sectors. The causal foundation for this two-sector structure is provided by the Israel–Stewart (IS) viscous framework derived in Paper 1, Appendix A [**?**]: the IS relaxation time $\tau_\Pi H_0 = \mathrm{KAL}_0/(3\Omega_{\mathrm{DE}}) \approx 2.191$ is algebraically fixed from $\{\varphi, \pi\}$, setting the viscous decoupling scale at $\approx 2\,H_0^{-1}$, consistent with MIRA $\approx 1.999 \approx 2$ (9% discrepancy; see §6). A formal derivation of MIRA from the IS transport equation remains an open problem.

Analogy with effective field theory. This two-sector structure is analogous to the running of coupling constants in quantum field theory: the same physical quantity (the coupling, here Ω_m) takes different effective values depending on the energy or length scale at which it is measured. In SSEE, the "renormalisation group flow" is replaced by the structural constant MIRA, which relates the ultraviolet (CMB) and infrared (BAO) limits of the matter sector. Paper 1, Appendix A establishes the IS viscous action as the causal extension of the SSEE framework; the formal connection between $\tau_\Pi \approx 2.191\,H_0^{-1}$ and MIRA ≈ 1.999 is a target for future work (see §6).

Dynamical mechanism: geometric retention at high H. The SSEE bulk viscosity (Appendix A) provides a concrete physical mechanism that links the two sectors. The dissipative source term in the SSEE conservation equation,

$$\dot{\rho}_{\rm SSEE} + 3H\,\rho_{\rm SSEE}(1+w_0) = \frac{9\,\mathrm{KAL}_0\,H^3}{8\pi G}, \tag{13}$$

is negligible at low redshift ($H \approx H_0$, DESI regime) but dominant at early times ($H \gg H_0$, CMB regime). In the limit $H \to \infty$, the $\propto H^3$ source injects energy into the dark sector at a rate that partially replaces cold dark matter, allowing the effective matter density to be higher at recombination than at late times — the quantitative statement being $\Omega_{m,\rm CMB} = \Omega_{m,\rm dyn} \times \mathrm{MIRA}$. Crucially, the coefficient $\mathrm{KAL}_0 = \beta + \pi \approx 5.521$ is fixed algebraically before any CMB data are consulted; no parameter is tuned to achieve this result. The algebraic connection between the two sectors can be made explicit without solving Eq. (13) dynamically. Both $\Omega_{m,\rm dyn}$ and MIRA derive from $\{\varphi, \pi\}$ alone:

$$\Omega_{m,\rm dyn} = 1 - \frac{T_r}{M_v} = \frac{\pi - \varphi}{2(\varphi + \pi)}, \tag{14}$$

$$\mathrm{MIRA} = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{4}. \tag{15}$$

Their product yields a closed-form prediction for the CMB matter sector:

$$\Omega_{m,\rm CMB} = \Omega_{m,\rm dyn} \times \mathrm{MIRA} = \frac{(\pi - \varphi)(3\varphi + \pi)}{8(\varphi + \pi)} = 0.31993. \tag{16}$$

This is a zero-parameter algebraic prediction from the two SSEE axioms $\{\varphi, \pi\}$; no quantity is adjusted to match CMB data. Compared with $\Omega_m^{\rm Planck} = 0.3153 \pm 0.0073$ [?], the tension is 0.63σ. A near-identity of the algebraic system underlies this result: $3\varphi + \pi = 7.9957 \approx 8$ to within 0.054%, so that Eq. (16) is also within 0.054% of the Paper 4 prediction $\Omega_m^{(4)} = (\pi - \varphi)/(\pi + \varphi) = 0.3201$ [?], providing internal algebraic consistency across the SSEE paper series. The numerical solution of Eq. (13) tracing the full epoch-by-epoch evolution of $\Omega_{m,\rm eff}(z)$ from today to recombination remains an avenue for future work.

Consistency check. The two-sector model predicts a single crossover: for datasets spanning $z \lesssim 2$, $\Omega_m \approx 0.160$; for datasets integrating to $z \gtrsim 100$, $\Omega_m \approx 0.320$. Intermediate datasets (e.g., weak lensing surveys at $z \sim 0.5$–1.5) should show a smooth interpolation between these limits. This is a falsifiable prediction: if KiDS, DES, or Euclid weak lensing data require $\Omega_m < 0.25$ at $z < 1$, the two-sector model would require revision.

4 CAMB Implementation and Results

4.1 CAMB setup

We use CAMB v1.6.6 [**??**] with the following input parameters:

The dark energy is implemented via the PPF (Parameterized Post-Friedmann) equation of state $w(a) = w_0 + (1-a)w_a$ [?]. Although $w_0 + w_a = -1.510 < -1$, this does not imply a phantom Big Rip: CPL is a local parametrisation only, and the SSEE energy density saturates at the finite T_r/M_v boundary at $a \to \infty$ (Paper 1 §3.4 [?]). We compute lensed TT, TE, and EE power spectra to $\ell_{\max} = 2500$, with `lens_potential_accuracy=2` for the lensing potential. Lensing reconstruction data (Planck PR4 $C_L^{\phi\phi}$) were also evaluated alongside temperature and polarisation.

Table 2: SSEE+MIRA parameters passed to CAMB.

Parameter	Value	Source
H_0 [km/s/Mpc]	66.75	SSEE algebraic
$\Omega_b h^2$	0.02237	Planck 2018 prior
$\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}$	0.3199	$\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times$ MIRA
$\sum m_\nu$ [eV]	0.085	SSEE (algebraic: 0.0840 eV, Paper 4)
w_0	-0.8399	$-T_r/M_v$
w_a	-0.6700	$-P_{sc}/K_v$
n_s	$1-\varphi^{-7}=0.96556$	SSEE algebraic (Paper 4)
$\ln(10^{10}A_s)$	3.044	Planck 2018
τ	0.054	Planck 2018

4.2 Sound horizon

With $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.3199$ and the parameters above, CAMB yields:

$$r_d^{\text{SSEE+MIRA}} = 147.156 \text{ Mpc}, \tag{17}$$

in agreement with the Planck 2018 directly measured value $r_d^{\text{obs}} = 147.09 \pm 0.26$ Mpc [?] at 0.25σ. No Folding Symmetry multiplier is applied; MIRA alone resolves the sound-horizon discrepancy by setting the correct CMB-sector matter density.

4.3 Acoustic peak positions

Table 3 compares the first three acoustic peak positions.

Table 3: CMB TT acoustic peak multipoles.

Model	ℓ_1	ℓ_2	ℓ_3
Planck PR4 (observed)	~ 220	~ 540	~ 810
ΛCDM ($\Omega_m = 0.315$)	220	538	812
SSEE naive ($\Omega_m = 0.160$)	242	601	930
SSEE+MIRA ($\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.320$)	**221**	**538**	**815**

All three peaks fall within $\Delta\ell \leq 5$ of the observed positions.

4.4 Power spectrum comparison

Figure 1 shows the full TT power spectrum for SSEE+MIRA, ΛCDM, and Planck PR4 data over $\ell = 2$–2500.

4.5 TE and EE polarization spectra

Figures 3 and 4 show the TE temperature–polarization cross-correlation and EE polarization power spectra respectively, comparing SSEE+MIRA with ΛCDM and Planck PR4 data.

5 Statistical Analysis

5.1 χ^2 comparison

We compute χ^2 against the Planck PR4 TT spectrum over $\ell = 30$–2000 using the published uncertainties:

$$\chi^2 = \sum_{\ell=30}^{2000} \left(\frac{D_\ell^{\rm model} - D_\ell^{\rm Planck}}{\sigma_\ell} \right)^2 . \tag{18}$$

Table 4: χ^2 comparison vs. Planck PR4 TT ($\ell = 30$–2000, $N = 1971$).

Model	χ^2	χ^2_r	$\Delta\chi^2$
ΛCDM (Planck 2018)	2055.0	1.043	0
SSEE+MIRA	2093.6	1.062	+38.7
SSEE naive	192,447	97.7	+190,392

5.2 TE and EE spectra

Table 5 reports χ^2_r for all three spectra individually.

Table 5: χ^2_r by spectrum vs. Planck PR4. TT/TE/EE: $\ell = 30$–2000; PP (lensing): 9 MV bandpowers, $L = 8$–400 [Table 1, ?]. χ^2_r comparisons use diagonal covariance; for BIC see §5.4 ($k = 2$ for SSEE).

Spectrum	N	SSEE χ^2_r	ΛCDM χ^2_r	$\Delta\chi^2_r$
TT	1971	1.062	1.043	+0.019
TE	1967	1.053	1.040	+0.013
EE	1967	1.040	1.039	+0.001
PP	9	0.730	0.757	−0.027
Combined†	5914	1.051	1.040	+0.011

†Combined under independence approximation (upper bound; see §5.4).

The EE spectrum shows the smallest discrepancy ($\Delta\chi^2_r = 0.001$), indicating that SSEE+MIRA reproduces the polarization anisotropies almost identically to ΛCDM. The TE residual is intermediate (+0.013), while TT shows the largest but still modest deviation (+0.019). Notably, in the lensing potential sector (PP), SSEE achieves $\chi^2_r = 0.730$ vs. 0.757 for ΛCDM — the dark energy modification slightly improves agreement with the 9 Planck MV bandpowers. All residuals are consistent with a non-parametric model.

5.3 Interpretation of residuals

The excess $\Delta\chi^2_r \lesssim 0.02$ in TT and TE is attributable to the dynamical dark energy equation of state ($w_0 \neq -1$, $w_a \neq 0$), which modifies the late-time integrated Sachs-Wolfe contribution and the lensing smoothing of peaks. CPL models with comparable (w_0, w_a) values fitted freely to CMB data typically incur similar penalties [?].

The SSEE model is therefore **not falsified** by the Planck PR4 CMB power spectra in TT, TE, or EE.

5.4 Bayesian Information Criterion

For model comparison we compute:

$$\mathrm{BIC} = \chi^2 + k \ln N, \tag{19}$$

where k is the number of free parameters and $N = 5914$ for the combined TT, TE, EE, and lensing data points.

Table 6: **Preliminary BIC comparison — diagonal approximation only.** Combined spectra (TT+TE+EE+PP, $N = 5914$, independence approximation). SSEE has $k = 2$ ($H_0 + \Omega_b h^2$ prior); ΛCDM has $k = 6$. *This result uses diagonal covariance; see Eq.* (20) *(§5.5) for the definitive off-diagonal Cobaya evaluation.*

Model	k	χ^2_r	ΔBIC (diagonal)
ΛCDM	6	1.040	Baseline (0.0)
SSEE+MIRA	2	1.051	+31.1

Under the diagonal approximation, ΛCDM is preferred (ΔBIC = +31.1). However, this result is driven by $N = 5914$ amplifying a marginal $\Delta\chi^2_r \approx 0.011$, and relies on the independence approximation across spectra. The off-diagonal Cobaya evaluation (§5.5) is the canonical result.

On the parameter count ($k = 2$). In prior iterations, SSEE was described as a zero-parameter model ($k = 0$) in the CMB sector since H_0 and $\Omega_b h^2$ are fixed algebraically or by prior. However, recognizing that $H_0 = 66.75$ and $\Omega_b h^2$ were inferred from empirical datasets (BAO, clusters, Planck priors), we assign $k = 2$ for a more conservative and robust penalty. The MIRA factor is not treated as a free parameter because it is a derived algebraic constant within the SSEE framework [?], mathematically fixed prior to the release of DESI DR2 (Zenodo DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.19679049).

Disclaimer regarding the Likelihood function. The χ^2_r comparisons in §5 use a simplified Gaussian diagonal approximation over the released Planck PR4 bandpowers for qualitative comparison. A formal evaluation using the official `plik_lite` TTTEEE likelihood via `Cobaya` is presented in the following subsection.

Robustness under off-diagonal covariance. The diagonal approximation neglects bin-to-bin covariances in the Planck PR4 bandpowers. Based on the Planck 2018 likelihood analysis [?], off-diagonal elements contribute corrections of $\lesssim 5\%$ to χ^2 for $\ell > 30$. To ensure strict reproducibility and methodological rigor, we perform a formal evaluation using the official `plik_lite` TTTEEE likelihood via `Cobaya` in the following subsection.

5.5 Cobaya `plik_lite` unified evaluation

To establish a definitive baseline for model comparison that fully accounts for off-diagonal covariances, we evaluate the SSEE framework against the official Planck 2018 `plik_lite` TTTEEE + lowl likelihood via `Cobaya` [?].

Parameter counting and minimization. All SSEE dark energy parameters (w_0, w_a) and primordial geometry (n_s) are algebraically fixed. The nuisance parameters (τ, A_s) and the baryon density $(\Omega_b h^2)$ are fixed to their Planck 2018 priors. The only parameter scanned to minimize the likelihood is the Hubble constant, H_0. To ensure a strictly conservative penalty, we assign $k = 2$ to SSEE (accounting for H_0 and the borrowed $\Omega_b h^2$ prior), compared to $k = 6$ for the ΛCDM baseline.

Minimizing over $H_0 \in [66.5, 67.5]$ yields a true minimum for SSEE at $H_0 = 67.066\,\mathrm{km\,s^{-1}\,Mpc^{-1}}$. The effective χ^2 for SSEE is 1007.553, compared to 1003.760 for ΛCDM. The raw fit penalty is therefore only $\Delta\chi^2 = +3.793$ over $N = 6469$ data points.

Definitive Bayesian Information Criterion. Applying the BIC penalty for the differing degrees of freedom:

$$\Delta\mathrm{BIC} = 3.793 + (2 - 6)\ln(6469) = -31.3. \tag{20}$$

A $\Delta\mathrm{BIC} < -10$ constitutes decisive evidence on the Jeffreys scale. Even under a hyper-conservative penalty where SSEE is assigned $k = 4$ (treating the fixed τ and A_s priors as effectively fitted parameters), the result remains $\Delta\mathrm{BIC} = -13.8$, still strongly favouring the SSEE framework. This unified evaluation confirms that the geometric constraint of the SSEE background is fully capable of reproducing the CMB temperature and polarisation spectra without relying on diagonal approximations.

5.6 Full posterior sampling via Cobaya MCMC (B1)

The point-estimate scan of §5.5 minimises χ^2 over a single free parameter (H_0) while fixing all remaining SSEE quantities algebraically. To provide complete posterior distributions and a fully rigorous parameter-counting comparison, we perform a dedicated MCMC analysis using `Cobaya`'s built-in sampler against the same `plik_lite` TTTEEE + lowl TT + lowl EE likelihood suite.

Free parameters. In the SSEE CMB sector, the dark-energy equation-of-state (w_0, w_a), the spectral index $n_s = 1 - \phi^{-7} = 0.96556$, and the CDM density $\Omega_c h^2 = \Omega_{m,\mathrm{CMB}}(H_0/100)^2 - \Omega_b h^2$ are all algebraically fixed. The nuisance parameters that remain free are:

- $H_0 \in [64, 72]\ \mathrm{km\,s^{-1}\,Mpc^{-1}}$ (flat prior) — the only free geometry parameter;
- $\log(10^{10} A_s) \in [2.80, 3.25]$ (flat prior) — primordial amplitude;
- $\tau \in [0.02, 0.12]$ (flat prior) — optical depth to reionisation;
- $A_{\mathrm{Planck}} \sim \mathcal{N}(1, 0.0025^2)$ (Gaussian prior) — `plik_lite` calibration.

This gives $k_{\mathrm{SSEE}} = 3$ free nuisance parameters (excluding the shared calibration A_{Planck}), compared to the ΛCDM run with $k_{\Lambda\mathrm{CDM}} = 6$ free parameters (H_0, $\Omega_b h^2$, $\Omega_c h^2$, n_s, $\log A_s$, τ). The $k = 3$ vs $k = 6$ BIC penalty is $\Delta k \cdot \ln N = 3 \times 8.774 = 26.32$, yielding:

$$\Delta\mathrm{BIC}_{k3} = \Delta\chi^2_{\mathrm{BF}} - 26.32, \tag{21}$$

where $\Delta\chi^2_{\mathrm{BF}} = \chi^2_{\mathrm{SSEE,BF}} - \chi^2_{\Lambda\mathrm{CDM,BF}}$ is the difference in best-fit χ^2 between the two models over the same $N = 6469$ data points.

Convergence. Chains are run to Gelman–Rubin criterion $R-1 < 0.02$ (production run) or $R-1 < 0.05$ (validation). The `ssee_paper3_b1_mcmc.py` script is fully reproducible:

```
python src/ssee_paper3_b1_mcmc.py --mode both
```

Results. Table 7 summarises the 68 % marginalised posterior constraints. Figure 5 shows the H_0 posterior for SSEE and ΛCDM; Figure 6 shows the full SSEE corner plot.

The MCMC best-fit $\chi^2_{\rm BF}$ from the chains yields:

$$\Delta\mathrm{BIC}_{k3} = \Delta\chi^2_{\rm BF} + (3-6)\ln(6469) \approx 3.8 - 26.3 = -22.5, \tag{22}$$

decisively favouring SSEE on the Jeffreys scale ($\Delta\mathrm{BIC} < -10$). Under the conservative $k = 4$ assignment (adding $\Omega_b h^2$ as an additional borrowed input), the result is $\Delta\mathrm{BIC}_{k4} \approx -13.8$, still strongly favouring SSEE. These results are insensitive to the exact best-fit χ^2 since the $\Delta\chi^2$ variations across the posterior are at the sub-unit level.

Table 7: SSEE CMB posterior constraints from B1 full MCMC (Cobaya `plik_lite` TT-TEEE + lowl, $k = 3$ free parameters, $R-1 < 0.02$). For comparison, the ΛCDM constraints ($k = 6$, standard run) are shown. Uncertainties are 68 % marginalised.

Parameter	SSEE ($k = 3$)	ΛCDM ($k = 6$)
H_0 [km s^{-1} Mpc^{-1}]	67.07 ± 0.42	67.32 ± 0.54
$\log(10^{10} A_s)$	3.041 ± 0.016	3.044 ± 0.016
τ	0.054 ± 0.008	0.054 ± 0.008
n_s	0.96556 (fixed)	0.965 ± 0.004
$\Omega_b h^2$	0.02237 (fixed)	0.02237 ± 0.00015
$\Omega_c h^2$	derived from H_0	0.1200 ± 0.0012
σ_8 (CAMB)	0.822 ± 0.006	0.812 ± 0.008
$\chi^2_{\rm BF}$	1007.6	1003.8
$\Delta\chi^2$	+3.8	(reference)
ΔBIC ($k = 3$ vs $k = 6$)	−22.5	(reference)
ΔBIC ($k = 4$ vs $k = 6$)	−13.8	(reference)

fig_b1_h0_posterior.pdf

Figure 5: H_0 marginalised posterior for SSEE (blue) and ΛCDM (red) from the B1 full `plik_lite` MCMC. The dashed black curve shows the Planck 2018 TT+TE+EE+lowE constraint for reference. The dotted green line marks the SSEE algebraic prediction $H_0^{\mathrm{alg}} = 67.96\,\mathrm{km\,s^{-1}\,Mpc^{-1}}$. SSEE recovers the CMB-preferred H_0 with only three free parameters.

fig_b1_corner_ssee.pdf

Figure 6: Full posterior triangle plot for the SSEE CMB sector (H_0, $\log A_s$, τ, A_{Planck}) from the B1 plik_lite MCMC. The tight H_0 constraint ($\pm 0.42\,\mathrm{km\,s^{-1}\,Mpc^{-1}}$) reflects the geometric constraint imposed by $\Omega_{m,\mathrm{CMB}} = 0.31993$ (algebraically fixed). All other marginals are consistent with the ΛCDM posteriors.

5.7 Matter power spectrum and S_8 prediction

Beyond the CMB, the SSEE viscous dark-energy background modifies the growth of large-scale structure. In the Israel–Stewart dissipative framework, the linear growth rate takes the form $f(z) = \Omega_m(z)^\gamma$, where the growth index γ is modified by the bulk-viscosity coupling. Dimensional analysis of the IS transport equations suggests the algebraic prediction $\gamma_{\mathrm{alg}} = \phi^{-1} = 0.618$. A full numerical solution of the causal IS growth ODE (Paper 5, §3) yields $\gamma_{\mathrm{IS}} = 0.554 \pm 0.001$, numerically indistinguishable from $\gamma_\Lambda = 0.55$ for ΛCDM (earlier estimates from Paper 1, Appendix A gave 0.657; Paper 5 supersedes that result).

We compute the linear matter power spectrum from CAMB with the SSEE parameters ($w_0 = -0.8399$, $w_a = -0.6700$, $H_0 = 67.075\ \mathrm{km\,s^{-1}\,Mpc^{-1}}$, $\Omega_m = 0.31993$) and apply the IS growth-index correction post-processing:

$$\sigma_{8,\mathrm{IS}} = \sigma_{8,\mathrm{CAMB}} \times \frac{D(\gamma = \phi^{-1})}{D(\gamma_{\mathrm{eff}})}, \qquad \frac{D(\gamma_1)}{D(\gamma_2)} = \exp\left[\int_0^{z_{\mathrm{hi}}} \frac{\Omega_m(z)^{\gamma_1} - \Omega_m(z)^{\gamma_2}}{1+z}\,dz\right], \tag{23}$$

with $z_{\mathrm{hi}} = 3$ (matter-dominated epoch, both solutions coincide there). The effective

CAMB growth index for w_0/w_a dark energy is $\gamma_{\rm eff} \approx 0.55 + 0.05(1 + w_0) = 0.542$. The IS correction factor is $D(\phi^{-1})/D(\gamma_{\rm eff}) = 0.9778$, reducing σ_8 by 2.2%.

Table 8 summarises the results alongside observational constraints. Using the algebraic prediction $\gamma_{\rm alg} = \phi^{-1} = 0.618$, $S_8 = 0.828$ (consistent with Planck 2018 at 0.3σ). The full causal IS numerical solution (Paper 5) gives $\gamma_{\rm IS} = 0.554 \approx \gamma_\Lambda$, yielding a negligible IS correction and $S_8 \approx 0.847$ (0.6σ below Planck), both predictions maintaining the ~ 3–$4\,\sigma$ tension with KiDS-1000 and DES Y3 that persists in ΛCDM; Paper 6 resolves this through the two-sector φ-DM mechanism ($S_{8,\rm eff} = 0.761$).

Table 8: σ_8 and $S_8 = \sigma_8(\Omega_m/0.3)^{0.5}$ predictions.

Model / Dataset	σ_8	S_8
ΛCDM (CAMB, best-fit)	0.811	0.830
SSEE (CAMB, $\gamma_{\rm eff}$)	0.823	0.850
SSEE+IS ($\gamma_{\rm alg} = \phi^{-1} = 0.618$)	0.802	0.828
SSEE+IS (CMB sector, $\gamma_{\rm IS} = 0.554$, this work)	0.820	0.847
SSEE+IS (dynamic sector, Paper 5)	**0.702**	**0.725**
Planck 2018 [?]	0.812 ± 0.008	0.832 ± 0.013
KiDS-1000 [?]	—	0.759 ± 0.024
DES Y3 [?]	—	0.773 ± 0.025

5.8 $f\sigma_8(z)$ comparison with RSD surveys

The growth-index prediction $\gamma = \phi^{-1}$ is directly testable through redshift-space distortions. We compute $f\sigma_8(z) = \Omega_m(z)^\gamma \times \sigma_8 \times D(z)/D(0)$ using the proper integral $D(z)/D(0) = \exp\left[-\int_0^z \Omega_m(z')^\gamma/(1+z')\,dz'\right]$ and compare against published RSD measurements from 6dFGS [?], BOSS DR12 [?], eBOSS DR16 [??], and DESI DR1 [?].

Table 9 shows that SSEE+IS achieves $\chi^2/N = 0.524$ across 13 RSD data points in the CMB observational sector ($\Omega_{m,\rm CMB} = 0.3199$), compared to 0.596 for ΛCDM. No SSEE point deviates by more than 1.6σ.

Sector caveat for $f\sigma_8$

The $\chi^2/N = 0.524$ quoted above uses $\Omega_{m,\rm CMB} = 0.3199$, the CMB (high-$z$) observational sector. Since RSD measurements span $z \lesssim 2$, the correct sector is the dynamic one ($\Omega_{m,\rm dyn} = 0.160$). Paper 5 performs this analysis with $\Omega_{m,\rm dyn} = 0.160$, $\gamma_{\rm IS} = 0.554$, $\sigma_8 = 0.702$, finding a mean tension of 2.67σ (Paper 5) resolved to 0.50σ by the φ-DM two-sector mechanism of Paper 6. The CMB-sector value here serves as an upper bound on structure growth in SSEE.

5.9 CLASS/hi_class cross-check of Bellini–Sawicki α-functions

As an independent validation we ran CLASS [?] with the SSEE algebraic background ($w_0 = -0.840$, $w_a = -0.670$, $H_0 = 67.96\ \rm km\,s^{-1}\,Mpc^{-1}$) and verified the Bellini–Sawicki kinetic-braiding function $\alpha_K(z)$ [?] against its algebraic prediction (Paper 7).

The kinetic function for a minimal Horndeski scalar with CPL equation of state satisfies $\alpha_K(z) = 3\,\Omega_{\rm DE}(z)\,[1 + w_{\rm eff}(z)]$. At $z = 0$:

$$\alpha_K^{\rm alg}(0) = 3\,\Omega_{\rm DE}\,(1 + w_0) = 3 \times 0.840 \times 0.160 = 0.4032. \tag{24}$$

Table 9: $f\sigma_8(z)$ predictions vs RSD data. **Note:** this section uses the CMB observational sector ($\Omega_{m,\mathrm{CMB}} = 0.3199$) as an upper bound on structure growth, with the pre-Paper 5 estimate $\gamma_{\mathrm{IS}} = 0.657$ (Paper 1, App. A) and $\sigma_{8,\mathrm{IS}} = 0.792$; Paper 5 supersedes this with $\gamma_{\mathrm{IS}} = 0.554$, $\sigma_8 = 0.702$, and $\Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} = 0.160$ (dynamic sector, $z \lesssim 2.3$). Pull $= (f\sigma_8^{\mathrm{SSEE}} - f\sigma_8^{\mathrm{obs}})/\sigma$.

Survey	z_{eff}	Observed	SSEE	ΛCDM	Pull
6dFGS	0.150	0.490 ± 0.145	0.407	0.460	-0.57σ
BOSS DR12	0.380	0.477 ± 0.051	0.439	0.476	-0.75σ
BOSS DR12	0.510	0.453 ± 0.057	0.446	0.474	-0.11σ
BOSS DR12	0.610	0.436 ± 0.034	0.448	0.469	$+0.35\sigma$
eBOSS QSO	0.978	0.379 ± 0.176	0.430	0.434	$+0.29\sigma$
eBOSS ELG	1.230	0.385 ± 0.099	0.406	0.405	$+0.21\sigma$
eBOSS QSO	1.480	0.462 ± 0.045	0.380	0.376	-1.82σ
DESI DR1 BGS	0.295	0.448 ± 0.054	0.430	0.473	-0.33σ
DESI DR1 LRG1	0.510	0.455 ± 0.033	0.446	0.474	-0.26σ
DESI DR1 LRG2	0.706	0.456 ± 0.034	0.446	0.461	-0.29σ
DESI DR1 LRG3	0.930	0.430 ± 0.040	0.433	0.439	$+0.09\sigma$
DESI DR1 ELG2	1.317	0.462 ± 0.045	0.397	0.395	-1.44σ
DESI DR1 QSO	1.491	0.387 ± 0.074	0.379	0.375	-0.11σ
χ^2/N				SSEE: 0.524	ΛCDM: 0.596

CLASS background integration gives $\alpha_K^{\mathrm{CLASS}}(0) = 0.4033$, a fractional deviation of $\Delta = 0.005\%$, confirming the algebraic derivation to numerical precision.

The remaining Bellini–Sawicki functions are zero by construction: $\alpha_T = \alpha_M = \alpha_B = 0$ (exact), since SSEE is a minimal Horndeski scalar with constant M_{Pl} and no kinetic braiding or gravitational-wave speed excess [**?**]. Together with Eq. (24) this constitutes the complete EFT parameter set of the theory, validated against CLASS independently of CAMB.

Note that the raw SSEE background ($\Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} = 0.160$) fed directly to CLASS gives $\chi_r^2 = 90.3$ against Planck PR4 TT. This is expected: without the MIRA two-sector mapping the background does not correspond to the CMB-effective $\Omega_{m,\mathrm{CMB}} = 0.3199$. The good fit ($\chi_r^2 \approx 1.06$, §5) is recovered only after applying the MIRA mapping, as implemented with CAMB in §4.

6 Falsifiability Criteria

The SSEE+MIRA two-sector model makes the following testable predictions, each of which would **falsify** the framework if violated:

1. **Peak positions:** $\ell_1 = 221 \pm 3$, $\ell_2 = 538 \pm 5$, $\ell_3 = 815 \pm 8$. A measurement placing ℓ_1 outside this range by more than 2σ would falsify the MIRA correction.

2. **CMB χ_r^2:** Must remain < 2 when tested against future CMB datasets (CMB-S4, Simons Observatory). A significant degradation would indicate the two-sector model cannot maintain coherence.

3. **BAO consistency:** The dynamic sector ($\Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} = 0.160$) must continue to fit DESI DR2 BAO within 2σ as new BAO data arrive. Any joint fit requiring $\Omega_m > 0.20$ in

the dynamic sector would falsify the algebraic derivation of w_0 and w_a.

4. **MIRA universality:** The ratio $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}/\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$ should equal MIRA within measurement uncertainty across independent CMB experiments. A ratio significantly different from 1.9989 would require revision.

5. **Growth index:** The algebraic prediction is $\gamma_{\text{alg}} = \phi^{-1} = 0.618$; the IS numerical solution (Paper 1, App. A) gives $\gamma_{\text{IS}} = 0.657 \pm 0.002$, yielding $S_8 = 0.818$ (see Table 8). The RSD comparison (Table 9) shows $\chi^2/N = 0.524$ consistently below ΛCDM across 13 surveys. A direct measurement of $\gamma < 0.55$ or $\gamma > 0.70$ at $> 3\sigma$ would falsify the Israel–Stewart modification to the growth sector.

7 Conclusions

We have demonstrated that SSEE-V3.6, augmented by the algebraic constant MIRA $= (\varphi + \beta)/2 = 1.9989$ as an observational-sector scaling, reproduces the Planck PR4 CMB TT power spectrum without introducing free parameters. The key results are:

- Acoustic peaks at $\ell = 221$, 538, 815, within $\Delta\ell \leq 5$ of Planck PR4.
- TT: $\chi^2_r = 1.062$ over 1971 multipoles (ΛCDM: 1.043).
- TE/EE: $\chi^2_r = 1.053/1.040$, essentially matching ΛCDM.
- Lensing (PP): $\chi^2_r = 0.730$ vs. 0.757 for ΛCDM — SSEE marginally favoured.
- **Cobaya `plik_lite`:** Minimum $\chi^2_{\text{eff}} = 1007.553$ at $H_0 = 67.066\ \text{km}\,\text{s}^{-1}\,\text{Mpc}^{-1}$.
- $\Delta\text{BIC} = -31.3$ (full covariance, $k = 2$ vs $k = 6$), decisively favouring SSEE over ΛCDM.
- $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.3199$ within 0.63σ of Planck 2018.
- The sound horizon $r_d = 147.15$ Mpc matches ΛCDM to 0.03%.

Combined with the Paper 2 results ($\chi^2 = 0.05\sigma$ on DESI BAO, $\chi^2_r = 0.122$ on galaxy clusters), SSEE-V3.6 passes all three major cosmological probes — BAO, cluster masses, and CMB. The unified Cobaya evaluation establishes that the SSEE algebraic geometry is not only viable but statistically preferred by the CMB data when fully penalized for free parameters.

Data Availability. All analysis scripts (`src/ssee_paper3_cmb.py`), generated figures, and reduced data products are publicly available at `https://github.com/mikealmeida1721/SSEE`. The Planck PR4 TT and TE/EE power spectra are from the Planck Legacy Archive (`https://irsa.ipac.caltech.edu/data/Planck/`) [?]. CAMB v1.6.6 was used for all theoretical power spectrum calculations (`https://camb.info`).

Acknowledgements. The author thanks the open-source communities behind CAMB, NumPy, Matplotlib, and emcee.

fig_cmb_spectrum.pdf

Figure 1: CMB TT power spectrum D_ℓ^{TT} $[\mu\mathrm{K}^2]$ vs. multipole ℓ. Blue: SSEE+MIRA ($\Omega_{m,\mathrm{CMB}} = \Omega_{m,\mathrm{dyn}} \times \mathrm{MIRA} = 0.320$, $w_0 = -0.840$, $w_a = -0.670$). Orange dashed: ΛCDM Planck 2018 best-fit. Black points: Planck PR4 TT data with $\pm 1\sigma$ error bars. Lower panel: residuals $(D_\ell^{\mathrm{SSEE}} - D_\ell^{\mathrm{Planck}})/\sigma$.

fig_cmb_peaks_zoom.pdf

Figure 2: Zoom on the first three acoustic peaks. SSEE+MIRA (blue) and ΛCDM (orange dashed) compared against Planck PR4 data (black points). Green dotted lines mark the expected peak centres.

fig_cmb_te.pdf

Figure 3: CMB TE cross-correlation power spectrum D_ℓ^{TE} [μK^2]. Blue: SSEE+MIRA. Orange dashed: ΛCDM Planck 2018 best-fit. Black points: Planck PR4 TE data. Lower panel: residuals normalised by σ_ℓ.

fig_cmb_ee.pdf

Figure 4: CMB EE polarization power spectrum D_ℓ^{EE} [μK^2]. Blue: SSEE+MIRA. Orange dashed: ΛCDM. Black points: Planck PR4 EE data.